

collaborations—whether with universities or partners—any IP developed under a C2i project belongs to the company, with clear agreements governing the use of third-party IP.

For OEMs and other customers, we treat them as clients, sharing differentiated features and performance as needed, while ensuring our core IP remains fully protected.

Who are your target customers and how do you position in India and globally?

The company's primary customers are global data centre operators, AI players, hyperscalers, network companies, and storage providers. We are actively engaging with them, demonstrating our silicon capabilities and receiving positive feedback on our feature set and performance targets. **In India, leading customers are evolving into self-sufficient OEMs by building servers and systems in-house, unlocking new pathways for indigenous product technologies.**

India is transitioning from deploying AI infrastructure to manufacturing it domestically. As Indian players begin building population-scale AI solutions, they will adopt more system engineering practices, creating semiconductor opportunities.

By first establishing success in global markets, the company aims to expand into the Indian ecosystem. While the government is developing initiatives under ISM 2.0 and ISM 3.0 to support domestic OEM and ODM capabilities, there are currently no dedicated programmes ensuring semiconductor products developed in India are consumed locally.

How does the company approach partnerships with OEMs, AI companies, or startups to scale the business?

Partnerships begin the moment the silicon is available, as performance metrics speak for themselves. We present our first-generation silicon to OEMs, ODMs, processor players, and other technology partners, demonstrating current capabilities alongside a clear roadmap for future generations, while also evidencing readiness for volume production.

Generation 1 establishes thermal, performance, and reliability benchmarks, while Generations 2 and 3 demonstrate how these metrics improve, building confidence in long-term collaboration.

Over time, we work closely with fabs, packaging vendors, and system integrators to define new process nodes, package technologies, and thermal solutions.

This multi-generation roadmap and end-to-end approach—rare even among large incumbents—forms the foundation for strategic partnerships and long-term scaling, driven from India by the startup team.

What challenges have you faced in scaling operations, hiring talent, and balancing R&D with commercialisation?

India has strong generic talent, but **finding engineers with domain expertise in high power AI applications and alignment with the company's mission has been a major challenge.** Competing with large corporations for experienced talent requires patience and careful selection.

A strong founding team enabled the development of the next layer of leadership. Motivating people to balance short-term stability with long-term impact is also critical.

Another challenge is keeping pace with a rapidly evolving AI market while building a multi-year technology roadmap from India. This requires a clear view of market direction, supported by informed judgment.

As India's ecosystem grows towards 'Make in India' AI infrastructure, both talent availability and market access should improve.

What is your vision for a 'Make in India' AI ecosystem in the future?

Our vision is to enable population-scale AI that is affordable and optimised for India's needs.

Today, AI infrastructure is expensive, but solutions built in India for India can reduce costs, improve accessibility, and ensure long-term efficiency and reliability.

We expect India to adopt a more distributed and edge-centric AI model, supporting applications such as speech, vision-based, and local-language AI on optimised infrastructure.

As the ecosystem evolves, more system-level design and semiconductor innovation will emerge from India, shifting the focus from 'assembled in India' to 'architected in India.' **EFY**

This interview is an excerpt of a longer discussion. For the full transcript, please visit: <https://efy.co.in/EFYMay2>



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